

Christy Yu

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

Masters in Human Computer Interaction, School of Computer Science

3.9 GPA | Aug. 2025 – Aug. 2026

Pittsburgh, PA

UC Santa Barbara

B.S. Computer Science, Statistical Science Minor

3.75 GPA | Aug. 2021 – Jun. 2025

Santa Barbara, CA

EXPERIENCE

Designer & Engineer Lead

Jan. 2026 - Jul. 2026

Collier Township (Capstone)

Pittsburgh, PA

- Centralized a 9k-resident township's civic feedback system, improved transparency and trust in policy-making
- Designed webapp and mobile platform that **raised average comprehension by 44%** of policy decisions, legal constraints, and budgeting, including with low tech-literate residents
- Built AI aid to retrieve and analyze civic data, **cutting time by 50%** for drafting new policies and grant proposals
- Validated product through 155 user tests, 30 qualitative interviews, 39 survey responses, and 6 in-person field visits across 13 iterations and 4 stages of research and design

Product Design Intern

Jan. 2026 - Present

PLUS – Tutoring platform of 3k+ students, 500+ tutors

Pittsburgh, PA

- Designed 4 end-to-end features, published design system components and dev hand-off documentation
- Collaborated with design lead, PM, and lead tutors to define product direction, specs, and edge cases for improving student-tutor matching algorithm quality
- Delivered 3 flows for student-tutor matching to incorporate language compatability, reduce manual fixes from supervisors, and support instant explicit overrides through database

UI/UX Design Intern

Jun. 2025 - Aug. 2025

Dawdle AI – Anti-procrastination app startup, featured in KCBS radio

San Francisco, CA

- Designed UI and flows with 30+ screens shipped to App Store launch with **200+ users at 5-star rating**
- Collaborated with CEO and cross-functional engineering team to strategize AI coaching features from beta feedback
- Built 40+ component design system in **Figma** reducing design-to-dev iteration cycles by **25%**

Founding Designer & Frontend Engineer

Oct. 2024 – Aug. 2025

JAFX – open-source guitar pedal startup

Santa Barbara, CA

- Secured **\$7,500** funding, **2nd in 44 teams** at UCSB New Ventures Competition, pitch deck co-wrote with CEO
- Established full brand identity and design system from scratch (logo, typography, color)
- Developed responsive main website (**Next.js & React**) (live at jaffx.audio)

Software Engineer Intern

Jun. 2024 – Aug. 2024

Lorentz Solution

Santa Clara, CA

- Migrated all 44 dynamic libraries from compiler RHEL6 to RHEL78 for PeakView chip-simulation(**Bash scripting**)
- Reduced **10%** in backup storage and production release package by automating library clean-up process

Data Analyst Research Fellowship

Jan. 2023 – Aug. 2025

Human Wildlife Conflict emLab

Santa Barbara, CA

- 3rd-authored research paper (published in **PNAS Nexus**) on climate-driven human-elephant conflict in Namibia
- Built and tuned **habitat suitability machine learning models** with land cover data and bioclimatic variables to visualize how climate change drives human-elephant conflict in **R**

PROJECTS

Refract | Anti-deepfake ID Protection ML software

Jan. 2024 - May. 2024

- * Built AI model and frontend app (**Tailwind/Javascript/CSS, Figma**) that disrupts identity-theft deepfakes model training, research poster winning 2nd in annual showcase
- * Cloaked images **disrupts deepfake models by 70%** with no visual difference to the human eye

Other projects on [GitHub](#)

SKILLS

Design: Visual UI, Prototyping, Usability Testing, Computer Vision, Data Science, UX Research, Product Strategy, Digital Products, HCI, Figma, Photoshop, Adobe, Claude Code,

Languages: Python, HTML/CSS/Javascript, TypeScript, R, SQL, C++, Java, Bash, MATLAB